

Chapter 20: Report Writing Workshop

Getting Started on Your Research Report

Gordon Wright

1 Overview

This chapter supports the **final lab**: turning your **returned analysis** (see the Week 20 **analysis showcase** on the site) into clean **APA-style Results** text and finishing the rest of the Research Report.

2 Getting Started

2.1 What You Have

- Your analysed data (from Gordon)
- All your project documents (Information Sheet, Procedure, etc.)
- The project articles and background reading
- APA reporting guidelines from Week 19

2.2 Writing Order

Don't write the report front-to-back. Instead:

1. **Method** — you already have everything you need (participants, design, materials, procedure)
2. **Results** — use your analysed data; report descriptive and inferential statistics in APA format
3. **Introduction** — build the argument for your hypothesis using the suggested readings and your own research
4. **Discussion** — interpret your results, connect to theory, discuss limitations
5. **Abstract** — write this last, once everything else is done

3 Key Reminders

3.1 Results Section

- Report *M* and *SD* for each condition (from your return sheet or your own tables)
- Report the inferential test in APA format: $t(df) = X.XX, p = .XXX$ (or F, r , etc., as appropriate)
- State whether the result was significant at $\alpha = .05$
- **Figures**: the website **preview** is a guide — for submission, use a **proper figure** (e.g. bar chart with error bars) with an APA **Figure caption** below the figure (number, title, note if needed)

- Do **not** paste the preview PNG as your only Results content; **write** the statistics into sentences and paragraphs
- State whether the hypothesis was supported (still in Results: factual alignment with prediction; deeper interpretation belongs in Discussion)

3.2 Discussion Section

- Start by restating your main finding in plain language (no statistics)
- Explain what the finding means in the context of the theory
- Compare to previous research — does your result agree or disagree?
- Be honest about limitations (sample size, materials, design)
- Suggest what future research could investigate
- End with a brief conclusion

4 Additional Resources

- Project Toolkit — your document reference
- Week 19 lecture reading — APA results reporting guidelines
- Week 20 **analysis showcase** — group-level analysis previews
- Week 20 lecture reading — discussion section writing guidance (optional)